

Orientation questions

When working with new repositories, it's a good idea to orient ourselves first with the files and the code in it. Doing so will give us a broad idea of what the repository does! In your answers file, write some notes on the following files.

If this is your first time seeing .php files and code, you can still do the activity below. Do not worry if you do not understand the files at first.

Without using Google/Documentation first!

Create_table.sql

- What do you think that this file does? What columns are created? What data types are stored in our columns? And which size is the data allowed to be? Which column holds the primary key (and why?) What do you think AUTO_INCREMENT does?

Get_data.php

- Observe on line 1 and 28 that we need to open and close a .php file. Write down the syntax to do so.
- Observe on line 2-5 that we are creating variables. Write down the syntax to create a variable in php.
- For each of the variables on line 2-5, describe what they are. What values should they hold in your case? (don't write this down, as this can be a threat to your IMS security)
- Line 8: what variable is created here, and why? What do you think is the purpose of line 10-12, why do we need this?
- Line 14: What does echo do? What would you call this statement in other programming languages you know?
- Line 14: you can see HTML code here. What do you think this echo statement returns?
- Line 17: here we are calling our \$link variable. Why do you think that is? Here we introduce a new operator: "->". Why do you think this operator is useful? Here we introduce a new method, query. What do you think this method does, and which parameter do we use?
- On line 19: we observe that num_rows is not coloured yellow like our methods. At the same time, it is not a variable either, since it does not start with \$. We call this a property access. What are we accessing, and from where?
- Line 19 - 25: a conditional loop is introduced. Can you guess what the output is of this code? Under which conditions?

Index.php

- Can you guess what the purpose is of this file? Hint: Think about your IMS. If the user is on the index page, where would they be?

Insert_data.html

- What do you think a form is in HTML?
- Take note of the post method, we will see it come back in the next file

Insertdata.php

New concept: In PHP, variables that start with `$_` are **superglobals**. Superglobals are special built-in arrays that PHP automatically creates and fills with data about the request, the server, the environment, etc.

- Line 16-21. What do you think the `$_POST` superglobal does?
- Line 23: here we prepare a SQL query. Why do you think the values are left blank for now? (?,?,?)

New concept: `bind_param` -> Bind variables for the parameter markers in the SQL statement prepared by `mysqli_prepare()` or `mysqli_stmt_prepare()`.

This method takes two parameters: a type definition string:

- s = string
- i = integer
- d = double/float
- b = blob (binary data)

And PHP variables to bind the placeholder values to.

- Line 27: Even though we have `$_POST['id']` data, we do not enter this into our database! Why is that? Think about our first file, `create_table.sql`
- Line 36: Close db connection. This is the first time we see this. Why does it occur here?